

Solid Ground



Introducing the foundation for doing business solo

Welcome



Doing this alone is hard. I'm not going to lie.

There is no one to ask at 10pm when you can't figure out how to word something. No one to split the bills with while you work out whether this is actually going to work. No one to say "I think you should go for it" when you're three seconds away from talking yourself out of it AGAIN.

Because I've done it. Solo business is what I've had to figure out. Each time I have relaunched, or leapt or had to make a hard decision that impacts not only my business, but my life outside of that.

I started my first business in 2020. No one by my side or to have my back. No one around me who'd done it. No one who could tell me the how, what's and why's. It was a figure it out as you go and make the mistakes along the way. That's why this exists.

I built this guide for the experience nobody writes about. Starting a business when it's all on you. When the table is quiet and there's no one to run it past.

Each section has been built with something you can actually do, not just read. This is not just a theory guide. There are also 3 bonus worksheets at the back that are yours to use however makes sense for your business and your life.

Start with one section. Start today.
You're already doing the hard part.

Jess x

What you actually need before you start

vs what everyone tells you

The real reason solo entrepreneurs over-prepare isn't perfectionism.

It's that launching without a partner means launching without someone at home saying "this looks good, go for it." So the bar keep moving,

One more course.

One more revision.

One more "almost ready".

Because the starting line also has to be the approval you're not getting from anywhere else.

Here's what you actually need:

- Something to offer.
- A way to get paid.
- One person who knows you exist.

That is all.

The rest get built in motion.

YOUR MINIMUM VIABLE START

- ☐ Something to offer (one service is enough to start)
- ☐ A way to take payment (Stripe, Paypal, bank transfer, cash)
- ☐ One person who knows you exist

That's the whole business. Start there.

The “I’ll start when...” trap

Spotting the stories that feel like responsibility

When you’re the only income “start before you’re ready” feels different to what it does in a business podcast. Let alone to those who have someone else bringing in an income to the household.

It takes a different kind of nerve to begin when there’s no one absorbing the financial risk with you. When there’s no one to make decisions with. It’s these things that feel less like fear and more like extra responsibility.

But those stories are not financial planning.

“I’ll start when I have more money” is not a budget; It’s protection. And it will move the goalposts forever, leaving you to having never started.

Starting isn’t irresponsible. Sometimes it’s the only way through.

NAME IT - THEN START ANYWAY

My current “I’ll start when...” story is:

What it’s actually protecting me from:

One step I’ll take this week regardless:

The free tools that do the jobs

No subscriptions before you've made a dollar

When you don't have a business partner to split costs with, you need to be deliberate about what you pay for and when.

The platforms that promise to streamline your business are designed for businesses already making money.

You may find that some of these platforms have a free tier or option you can trial before subscribing. Great for exploration before commitment

However, while you're not there yet start free.

Upgrade only when a tool is genuinely holding you back from expanding.

YOUR ZERO COST TOOLKIT

Google Workspace - Email, calendar, docs, google meet, note keeping. Everything to run and organise a business.

Canva (Free Tier) - Graphics, posts, documents, PDFs. No design skills needed.

Stripe or Paypal - Setup and take payment in 20mins. No setup costs. Small processing fee.

Calendly (Free) - Booking link you can share anywhere. Clients sort themselves.

- Not ready to make that leap to a booking system? Add each appointment to you calendar manually with its own specific colour.

Instagram - Your first window. Free. Start before it's perfect.

Where your first clients come from

Your network is smaller - and entirely yours

Your network is not a combined household network.

You don't have access to a partner's colleagues, their school friends, their LinkedIn connections. What you have is smaller. But it's 100% warm to you - not to a household, not to a couple. To you specifically.

That's not a disadvantage.

The people who know you have seen you show up. When they refer you, they mean it.

Tell them what you do. Don't assume they know.

Say it in a message, at pickup, in a post that feels a bit too honest. That vulnerability isn't oversharing.

It's the beginning of trust.

A MESSAGE YOU CAN SEND TODAY

Hey (name) - I just wanted to let you know I've started (what you do). If you know anyone who might need (what you offer), I'd really appreciated the mention. No pressure."

Then post something too. Both. Today

How to set up to get paid

When price carries more weight, get clear on it early

When you're the only one earning, your price carries more weight than it does for someone with a financial safety net.

That weight can push you to underprice. To add extras that weren't asked for. To discount before anyone asks. To accept "pay you later" and let it go.

Know your number before anyone asks for it.

Send a payment link, not "let me know when you're ready." Invoice the day you deliver.

You're allowed to run your business like a real business, even in week one. Especially in week one.

One more thing: open a separate bank account just for business income. It doesn't need to be a business account - a separate personal account works. When your business money lives in its own place, you can actually see what's coming in. Your wins stay visible instead of disappearing into the household.

BEFORE YOUR FIRST CLIENT, CHECK OFF:

- ☐ My price is set and I can say it without hesitating
- ☐ Stripe or Paypal is set up and I've sent a test payment
- ☐ I have a payment link ready to send in under a minute
- ☐ I will invoice the same day I deliver - no exceptions
- ☐ A separate bank account for business income is open

Making decisions alone

When the table is quiet and it's all on you

There is no one at the kitchen table to ask.

Not just no business partner - no one. The decision sits with you at 11pm, and you're the only one it lands on.

Some things that actually help:

- Trust your gut before the over thinking starts
- Write it out - clarity comes in the writing
- Find your people, because there are communities who are doing exactly this who will get it without you having to explain.

And when you need a real thinking partner, book a session.

That's not a weakness. It's knowing your resources.

You don't need all the answers. You just need to keep moving.

WHEN YOU'RE STUCK, WRITE IT OUT

The decision I keep circling:

What my gut said first, before the overthinking:

What I'll do by (due date):

*You don't need to have it
all figured out.*

You just need to begin.



What's Next..

Ready to go deeper?

The Solid Ground self-paced course takes every section further - exercises, prompts and a clear path forward. Your pace, your time.

energywithjess.com.au

Want to work through it with me?

Book an Align + Flow session or a Soul-Led Business Discovery Call.

We can figure it out together.

energywithjess.com.au/booking

Come find me on Instagram, Facebook & Tiktok

[@energywithjess](https://www.instagram.com/energywithjess)

Money Check-in

One quick look at where you stand

Fill this in at the end of each week. You don't need to be exact

The goal is awareness, not accounting.

[illegible]

First Wins Log

No one else is tracking your progress - so you do it

Record your firsts here. Date them. These are the moments that prove it's working. When it feels slow, come back to this page.

Don't forget to add your own personal milestones.

- [illegible]

My Own Tracker

Label it yourself. Use it for whatever you need most right now.

This one's yours to make. Label the columns however works for you.

Clients, content, income, sessions, ideas, anything. NO RULES HERE.

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